

BA Portfolio Project — Planning Document

Inventory Mismatch Dispute Resolution — E-Commerce Supply Chain

Prepared by: Karthika Ayyanan | Domain: E-Commerce / Supply Chain | Started: April 12, 2026

1. Project Overview

This portfolio project documents the end-to-end Business Analyst process for investigating and resolving an inventory mismatch dispute between SnapMart Sellers and QuickKart, a large e-commerce platform. The project covers requirements elicitation, stakeholder analysis, process modeling, root cause analysis, gap analysis, and data analysis — resulting in a full suite of BA artifacts.

2. Problem Statement

Business Context

SnapMart Sellers is a mid-sized seller that lists and sells products to customers through QuickKart, a large e-commerce platform. SnapMart stores its inventory in QuickKart's fulfillment warehouse, which handles picking, packing, and shipping orders on SnapMart's behalf.

The Problem

A critical inventory mismatch exists between SnapMart's internal system, which records 500 units dispatched to QuickKart's fulfillment warehouse, and QuickKart's system, which shows only 320 units received — a discrepancy of 180 units. This mismatch has resulted in order failures, customer dissatisfaction, and an active dispute between SnapMart and QuickKart over accountability for the missing inventory.

Stakeholders Affected

The inventory mismatch directly impacts multiple stakeholders — SnapMart's Inventory Team, Finance Team, and Management; QuickKart's Warehouse/Fulfillment Team and Seller Support Team; the third-party Logistics/Delivery Partner responsible for transporting inventory; and end customers whose orders could not be fulfilled.

Objective

The objective is to investigate and resolve the inventory mismatch by:

1. Tracing the 180 missing units across the supply chain to determine where the discrepancy occurred
2. Establishing accountability by identifying the responsible party — SnapMart, QuickKart, or the logistics partner
3. Defining a structured process for resolving affected customer orders
4. Determining financial repercussions and repayment terms if SnapMart is found at fault
5. Recommending preventive measures and standardized inventory verification practices to avoid recurrence

3. Key BA Activities

BA Activity	Purpose in This Case Study	Expected Output
Requirements Elicitation	Understand each stakeholder's account of the dispute and gather resolution needs	Stakeholder interviews, requirement list
Stakeholder Analysis	Identify all involved parties and map by Power/Interest to prioritize engagement	Stakeholder Matrix, Power/Interest Map
Process Modeling	Map current dispatch and warehouse receiving process to identify breakdown points	Process Flow / BPMN Diagram
Root Cause Analysis	Determine the actual reason behind the 180 unit discrepancy	RCA Report / Fishbone Diagram
Gap Analysis	Compare current process vs. ideal process to find missing or broken steps	Gap Analysis Table
Data Analysis	Examine dispatch records and GRN data from both parties to trace missing units	Data Comparison Report

4. Project Planning & Timeline

Working pace: 2-3 hours/day | Approach: Sequential | Target completion: April 26, 2026

#	Deliverable	Phase	Start Date	Due Date	Status
1-4	Project Setup & Visioning (Theme, Problem Statement, BA Activities, Planning Doc)	Setup	Apr 12	Apr 12	Done
5	Business Requirements Document (BRD)	Artifact Dev	Apr 13	Apr 15	Not Started
6	Business Use Case Diagram	Artifact Dev	Apr 16	Apr 16	Not Started
7	Process Flows	Artifact Dev	Apr 17	Apr 18	Not Started
8	Stakeholder Matrix	Artifact Dev	Apr 19	Apr 19	Not Started
9	RACI Matrix	Artifact Dev	Apr 20	Apr 20	Not Started
10	Context Model	Artifact Dev	Apr 21	Apr 21	Not Started
11	Walkthrough + Lessons Learned	Documentation	Apr 22	Apr 23	Not Started
12	Screenshots & Mockups	Documentation	Apr 24	Apr 24	Not Started
13	GitHub Repository Setup	Publishing	Apr 25	Apr 25	Not Started
14	LinkedIn & Portfolio Post	Publishing	Apr 26	Apr 26	Not Started